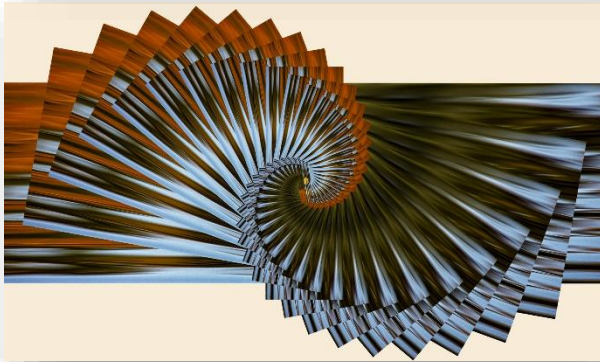
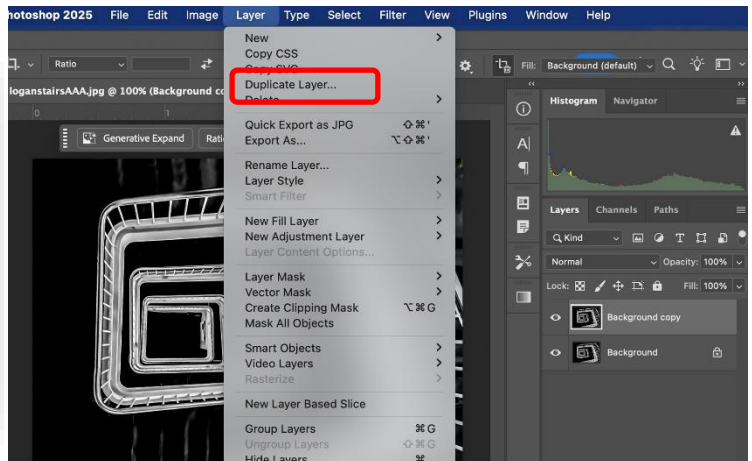


Digital Technique - Spirograph



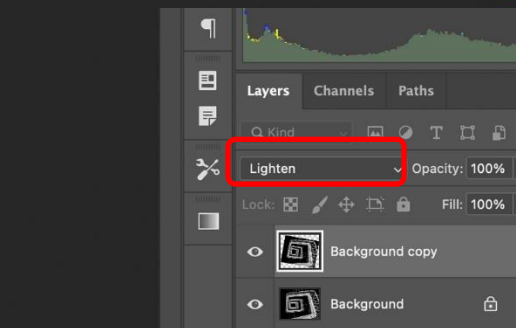
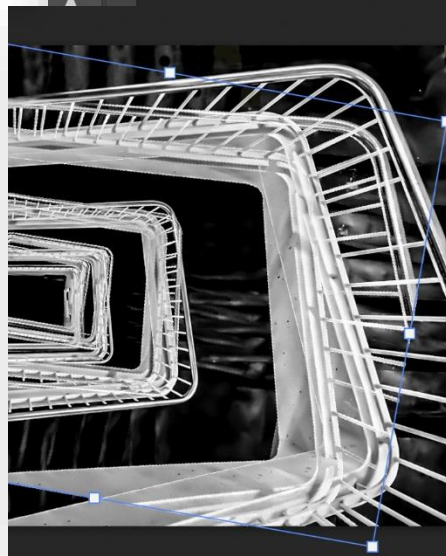
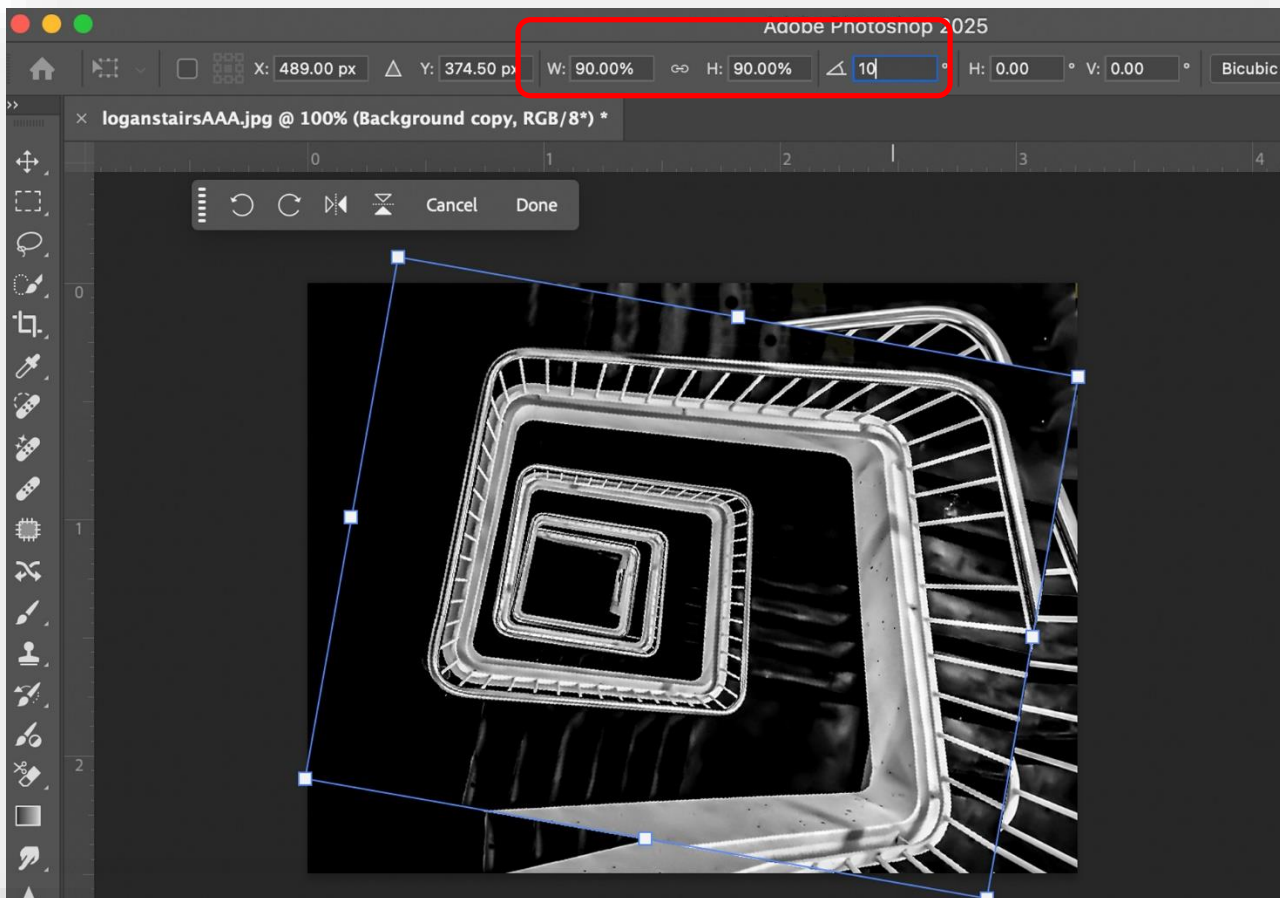
Duplicate Layer:

Once you have a photo open, make a copy of the image layer (Ctl-J or your favorite method).



Rotate and Move:

Now Transform the layer you created above, by pressing **Ctrl-T** (or use the menu for Free Transform). With the Transform settings that come up across the top of the window, change the W (width) and H (height) values to 90%. Also set the angle to 10°. Now click the check mark to apply the transformation.



Pick a Layer Blend mode:

At the top of your Layers panel there is a drop down list, which says "Normal" by default. Click on this and select "Darken". Now watch your image while pressing the down arrow key to cycle through the different layer blend modes (Darken, Multiply, Color Burn, etc.). When you see the two layers blend in an interesting way, stop at that blend mode.

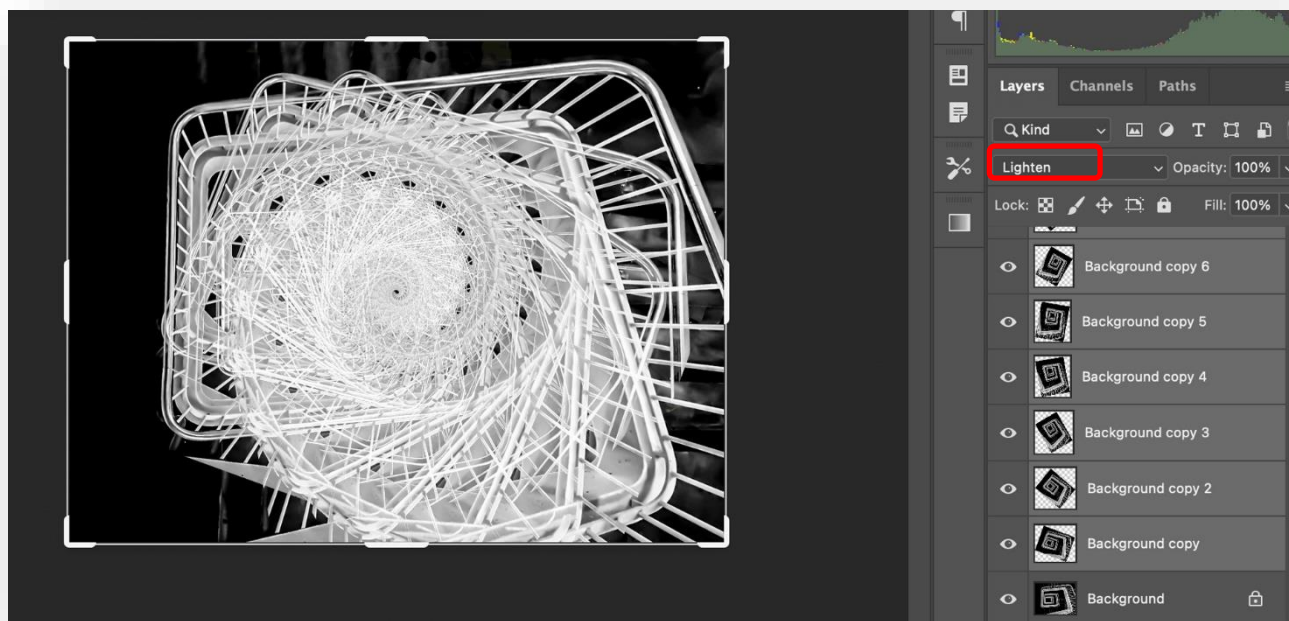
Repeat the Transform with a magic key combination:

Ctl-Alt-Shift-T is the magic key combination. It creates a copy of the layer and applies the previous transformation at the same time. We want to do this multiple times, resulting in many copies of the original layer, with each copy smaller and more rotated.

So, press Ctl-Alt-Shift-T (yes, that is 4 keys, but you can do it 😊). (*Cmd-Option-Shift-T on a mac*)
Press Ctl-Alt-Shift-T again and again and again.

If you don't like how it is turning out (it's all becoming one white or black blotch), then undo those few Transforms (copies) and try a different blend mode.

If you are liking the pattern you see, then keep pressing Ctl-Alt-Shift-T, until you get a final result that you like. Frequently I end up with between 15 and 30 layers (copies). But for the right photo, a full 360 rotation (full circle) can look great. For the full circle, you'll need 36 copies.

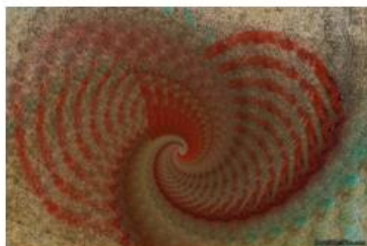


Done? Or Rinse and Repeat?

You can call it day if you are thrilled with the abstract image you have created. But I would suggest repeating the edit with different Transformation values (Width, Height, Angle), or even leaving out one or the other of the changes for a totally different look.

Using different Layer Blend Modes and different photos will give you totally different results! So make sure you try this with different photographs and blend modes.

With Darken Blend Mode:



With Darken Blend Mode:



With Lighten Blend Mode:



With Lighten Blend Mode:



Summary Cheat Sheet

Here is the above process in a nutshell.

Open Photo:

Duplicate Layer: Ctl-J

Transform: Ctl-T

Change Height, Width and/or Angle.



Copy and Transform: Ctl-Alt-Shift-T

REPEAT: Press Ctl-Alt-Shift-T again,
multiple times (perhaps 15, 30 or even 36)

Tweak Image: Crop, Saturation, Curves, Levels, etc...

Save: Don't forget to save your work!

